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Request for Information: Development of an Artificial Intelligence Action Plan

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Submitter Information

Name: Bruce Hartzell

[REDACTED]

General Comment

From:

Bruce Hartzell

Writer

3965 Michael Avenue,

Los Angeles, CA 90066

Re: National Science Foundation's Request for Information on the Development of an Artificial Intelligence (AI) Action Plan

I am an everyday American who makes a living as a writer and copywriter. I worked for years to hone my skills, craft, and abilities, and I have been fortunate enough to make a living as a writer.

The AI systems developed by major tech companies, such as OpenAI (Microsoft) and Google, pose a threat to thousands of American small businesses and creatives with their recent demand for special carve-outs in copyright law.

AI systems are plagiarism machines. The so-called training is theft by another name. These companies have used my creations and those of countless other artists, writers, and musicians without our consent. They steal our work, regurgitate it, and then sell it back to our clients, directly competing with us and cutting us out of the marketplace.

These thieves are now asking to create exceptions and loopholes to make this practice of stealing American creators' copyrighted work legal precedent. They are suggesting that if a machine ingests and reproduces copyrighted work, it is somehow suddenly "fair use" and necessary for their businesses.

To codify this criminal act will destroy the lives of countless Americans and damage our economy.

If we the American people do not own our creations, and everything we put online will be stolen by Big Tech giants, what will be the incentive to create? If everyday Americans create a new innovative piece of computer code, a new visual design, or a new piece of music only to have it immediately stolen by Google and Microsoft, why bother creating it in the first place? How will we possibly make a living doing these things?

American creators must be protected. Our creations are seen around the world and are a major source of American economic strength. You cannot give them permission to steal the work of others. Do not create new copyright exemptions that allow Big Tech companies to exploit and steal from creators and everyday Americans without permission, compensation, or transparency.

This administration's AI Action Plan should focus not on giving away creator content to Big Tech companies, but rather on ensuring a fair marketplace with competition:

- First, the government should ensure that both creators and everyday Americans provide informed consent, so we can determine when and how our work is used by AI systems.
- Second, the AI Action Plan should encourage a robust licensing marketplace to preserve the incentive for small businesses to create. Our work has immense economic value, and the value generated by that work should accrue to the original creators, not just Big Tech.
- Finally, the AI Action Plan should require transparency from Big Tech companies. It should require them to disclose what material is in their training datasets and label what content is AI-generated.

Technology has made a huge difference in the world, but we can't destroy the livelihood and allow the theft of people's work without permission.

Thank you for the opportunity to comment on these important issues.